

techno_funky

Joined **02 Dec 2003**

Posts **776**

Location **Mumbai**

Post Subject **Digitized!**

Bill Gates has been staring into his crystal ball and sees no future for the DVD. In an article published in the German mass-circulation daily *Bild*, Gates reckoned that DVD technology would be "obsolete in 10 years at the latest." He said the concept of carrying around film and music on little silver discs to stick them into a computer was ridiculous. He moaned that DVDs could get scratched or get lost.

Gates said that the home computer will know who we are from our voice or our face. It will know what we want to watch, or what the kids shouldn't be allowed to see. Here the crystal ball clouded over due to a blue screen of death. Bill's predictions and his crystal balls can be a little inaccurate. He once said that there was no future in that little networking novelty called the Internet!

deleted_empathy

Joined **04 Jul 2004**

Posts **45**

Posted **Wed Mar 17, 2004 10:03 am**

Post Subject **Warmed-Up Nerd**

Bill Gates says a lot of things. He was of the opinion that 640 KB of memory will be more than what one will ever need. He also said that Linux is just a '60s technology wrapped in a new package. How come then that '60s technology and its various cousins still give those Microsoft guys sleepless nights when they think of the server market?

Everything evolves. Dumb people keep getting replaced by saner, efficient ones. Quite on the lines of the Theory of Evolution. I have referred to Charles Darwin, though I personally feel he didn't have that great traits of intelligence, which many associate him with, but that's another story.

Technology is no exception. Most of the current-generation DVD technology, for example, is based on the red part of the light spectrum. The efficiency can be—and this is already being done—increased moving further down the spectrum and selecting lower wavelengths. Then come the different concepts themselves. Like those cool 3D holographic methods, for example.

So I am not surprised that Bill Gates had to rack his brain to come up with the idea of DVDs having no future. Which can be obvious to a 10-year-old school dropout as well!

Mail order

E-mail users across the world should be indebted to Google. It wasn't until Google changed the rules of the game that free e-mail service providers Yahoo, Hotmail and Rediff woke up and went beyond the 2 MB to 6 MB limits they had.



The result was that, literally, all our important e-mail had to be deleted in the name of housekeeping. Not any longer. Google's announcement of 1000 MB inboxes left the rest scurrying to increase the size of their e-mail boxes. Now our *desi* Rediff offers 1 GB (24 MB more than Google!); Yahoo gives 100 MB; and Hotmail has promised a 250 MB free e-mail box.

So what would distinguish one from the other? Two things: service and spam. Factors such as accessibility, recall and speed would ensure better service. As for spam, Bayesian filters seem all set to become the standard to battle it, and so it is left to be seen who wins the race.

Until then—just as we did with search—let us thank Google.

Madhulika Mathur
Agra

SMS alert

Until recently, SMS was a great way to communicate. It opened a new window of opportunity to shy people who otherwise would not have gathered the courage to say something.

However, the fun things about a new, useful technology have lasted only this long. Of late, SMS spoofing has become alarmingly common. So much so that people have started distrusting messages from their own friends and family members. SMS spam is another hazard people have come to accept.

The question is: Do we really need to? While SMS spam violates the privacy of cell phone users, spoofing is set to bolster fraud. Tricksters can now make use of Web-based software specifically meant to

defraud through SMS. One can send misleading messages to people by using the cell phone numbers of other people. The person whose number is used wouldn't even know that his number is being used in sending messages to others.

The biggest bother is that one is helpless to mobile phone spam, as unsolicited messages cannot be blocked. Only a ban on advertising through SMS can stop this nuisance.

Ashu D'Souza
Mysore

Wake up, Google!

Looks like Google has competition. I recently read about a new search engine called Blinkx, developed by Kathy Rittweger and Suranga Chandratillake. Some say it has an edge over Google because it doesn't just search the Web but also crawls news sites, e-mail attachments, our hard disk, and also blogs.



One has to download the Blinkx windows client, which automatically finds Web pages and documents related to the content of the active window or based on a specific query.

Also, Blinkx claims to use artificial intelligence to rate stories—not page rankings like Google. My fellow Digit readers can download a beta version on <http://www.blinkx.com/>.

Will it beat Google. We don't know that yet.

Satyabrat Chakraborty
Rourkela

Thank you for the story

The July issue of *Digit* fed me to the gills every bit of information about cellular phones—be they the regular ones, or camera phones, or even smart phones.

All I can say is, thank you.

Having said that I would also like to